

Chicken Pesto Pasta

Serves: 4 | Prep: 5 min | Cook: 20 min

INGREDIENTS

- 400g penne or farfalle pasta
- 500g chicken breast, cut into bite-sized pieces
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt, pepper, Italian seasoning
- 1/2 cup basil pesto (jar or homemade)
- 1/2 cup heavy cream
- 1/2 cup pasta cooking water (reserved)
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- 3/4 cup parmesan, freshly grated
- Fresh basil to serve

METHOD

Step 1

Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil. Cook pasta to al dente per packet directions. Reserve 1/2 cup pasta water before draining.

Step 2

Season chicken with salt, pepper and Italian seasoning. Heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Cook chicken 5–7 minutes until golden and cooked through. Set aside.

Step 3

Reduce heat to medium. Add pesto and cream to the same skillet, stirring to combine. Simmer 2–3 minutes.

Step 4

Add drained pasta, chicken, cherry tomatoes and a splash of pasta water. Toss everything together until well coated and glossy.

Step 5

Remove from heat, stir in parmesan, top with fresh basil and serve immediately.

TIPS & NOTES

- ◆ *Don't heat the pesto above a simmer or it will lose its bright green colour and fresh flavour.*
- ◆ *The starchy pasta water is liquid gold — it helps bind the sauce and gives it a silky texture.*
- ◆ *Use rotisserie chicken as a time-saver — just shred and add at the sauce stage.*